

pointing governors* over all the conquered provinces, returned to Ecbatana.

The following historical account of the approach of Cyrus on Babylonia and the fall of that empire may be gathered from the Annals of Nabonidus and the Cyrus Cylinder.

The record of the Annals, which must have been very complete, is unhappily so mutilated that comparatively little can be learned about the early period of the invasion. We may conjecture from a very broken passage (*col. ii. l. 21-22*) that the Persians may have made an invasion from Elam against Erech in the tenth year of Nabonidus (see note to passage, APPENDIX I), but this is by no means certain. Where the text treating of the actual conquest of Babylon is legible, the matter seems practically to be decided. It is stated that Nabonidus entered the Temple of *Eturkalama* (Annals, iii. 6), most probably to seek help from the gods. We may then conjecture,—the translation is very doubtful,—that a rebellion against his authority took place on the lower sea. The god Bel was apparently brought out with a solemn religious festival (*col. iii. 8. 9. 10*), and, as a last resource, numerous deities were brought to Babylon as a protection to that city. This, says the chronicler of the 'Cyrus Cylinder,' so infuriated Marduk, the god of the city of Babylon, that he decided to deliver up Nabonidus to Cyrus (see Cyl. 10^{ff.} and 33, 34). In the month Tammuz (539 B. C.) Cyrus offered battle at Opis and apparently also on a canal (?) Salsallat, which evidently resulted in his favor. (See note to Annals, *col. iii. l. 12*, APPENDIX I.) The Babylonians, defeated on all sides and disgusted with their feeble king, surrendered Sippar to the Persians on the 14th of Tammuz (539-538 B. C.; see Annals iii. 14). As this city was the key to the whole sluice region it was important for Cyrus to get possession of it before he could besiege Babylon successfully. By breaking the dams at Sippar in case of need, the water could be cut off from all the plain. As we have seen, according to the account of Herodotus just

* See Herodotus, i. 153. The post of governor of Sardis was one of the most important positions in the Persian Empire. This official seems to have held the precedence over the neighboring satraps. Compare Nöldeke, *Aufsätze zur altpersischen Geschichte*, p. 21.